



What do you knoll?

Astronomical knolling can be a very fascinating subject.

<http://dgit.in/1Ds9N30>



This Xiaomi charger is quite a steal

Cables

While it's cute and convenient to see powerbanks trying to bundle a bunch of cables and connectors to make them as widely appealing as possible to prospective customers. I always recommend using the original USB charging cable you received with your smartphone or tablet, because it's best suited for charging that particular device.

Think of it this way, just like a cable that comes with a powerbank will be geared towards preserving its best interest, similarly your smartphone, tablet, camera or handheld gaming device's original charging cable is made to preserve and protect those unique devices from the hazards of electrical charging. Also, these original cables will usually come with an in-built fuse for an added layer of protection.

One for all

While we have covered some of the finer points to consider while buying a powerbank, let's not forget its biggest, most basic purpose – to charge devices, and if a powerbank has the ability to charge every device that you own, it automatically becomes one of the most important factors in your purchasing decision. Having to carry one power bank for your phone and another for your tablet is too much of a fuss – a great thumb rule here is to find a powerbank that can charge an Apple iPad, since they require 2.1 A output, which most powerbanks can't pump out – they only manage about 1 to 1.2 A. If you can find a powerbank that can charge an iPad, it generally means it's something that can charge almost any other smart mobile device that you might own.

Then there is the issue of having so many interfaces to comply with, though chargers these days don't have the cable affixed to them, which means that you can make do with just a USB port on your power bank. But for older generation devices, it makes sense to have adaptors. Hence, a power bank that can not only charge all your devices but also do it simultaneously would be the perfect choice. Follow my advice and make the right purchase decision. 

GAME ARTIST VS. ANIMATOR: WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE?

When people learn that I work in the games industry, they think that my job revolves around playing games all day. The second misconception is that a lot of people associate video game artists with animators. Sure, a game artist and an animator do similar things: they draw. But that's where the similarities end.

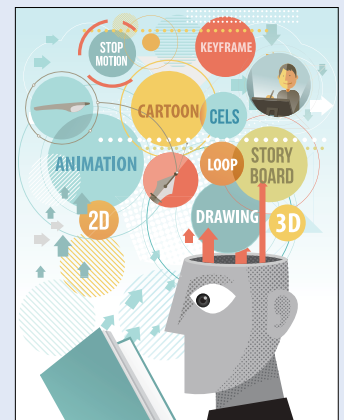
Like an animator, a game artist can specialize based on their skillset: Concept Artist, Promo-Artist, Texture Artist, 3D modeler, Rigging & Animation Artist, Technical Artist and UI Artist. But one of the major differences in the production of an animation and a game is the limit of polygons that a game can use. Polygons are like the atoms of any game asset. In an animation, since the movie is rendered beforehand, the frame-rate problem is non-existent and so is the polygon limit on the assets. The production mentality in most game studios is: "less is more". So an artist looking to make it in the game industry, must understand these nuances.

An artist can no longer just draw and expect the game to create itself. Having experience in engines like Unity, Unreal and the like could be the edge in job interviews between one artist and the next. Engine knowledge is of prime importance when designing assets and managing their file-size. Another major difference is that game artists work very closely with programmers and designers in their team.

A game artist and an animator use different tools, have different work environments and modus operandi. While what we do might elementally be the same, the end result and the way we do it, is essentially different. This is rightly why Game Art and Animation are two separate streams at DSKIC (Supinfocon & Supinfocon). Under the guidance of the trainers at the institute and with my personal drive, I was able to learn a lot more than I could hope for at any other institute in India. Working on team-projects became viable as I met a lot of like-minded individuals. And working becomes easier when the institute provides high-end systems. Their *Build Your Own Game* competition is a great way to make your first game and is an invaluable experience.

In the end, being a successful game artist solely depends on you. You could be provided with all the top-notch facilities in the world, but you need the drive to push forward and improve. The goal of perfection is light-years away, but you can always get closer with each step.

Written by *Rahul Narayanan*, a professional video game artist and DSKIC alumnus. For more visit www.dsk.digit.in.



Journey from concept to creation